

Normalization: Why we need it?

- Stabilize and accelerate training
 - Improves conditioning
 - Enables larger learning rates with faster convergence.
- Improve gradient flow
 - Reduces vanishing/exploding gradients, allowing deeper networks
 - Make training less sensitive to weight initialization and learning rate choices.
- Decouple scale from representation
 - Makes networks robust to input scale and distribution shifts across layers

Why Layer Normalization?

- Batch-size agnostic
 - Works consistently for batch size 1 or variable batch sizes
- Ideal for sequence models
 - Sequences are usually of variable length
 - BatchNorm is NOT preferred due to dependency of batch of data
- Widely used in Transformers and RNNs,

Why Batch Normalization?

- Stabilizes Learning by mitigating *internal covariate shift*
- Acts as a regularizer
 - Reduces the need for dropout
- Enables Higher Learning Rates
 - Stable distributions allow large learning rates
 - Speed up convergence
- Improves Gradient Flow
 - Prevents activations from becoming too large or small
 - Avoids vanishing or exploding gradients

How to Choose?

- Use Case
- Always
- CNNs with
- Sequence M
- Transforme

# of FLOPs for maxpool: $C_{in} * O_n * Q_n * (k^2 - 1)$ k = ker size. # of comparisons. # of FLOPs per layer: $C_{out} * h_{out} * w_{out} * 2 * C_{in} * k_h * k_w$	<u>Transformers</u> RNNs/LSTMs: • Sequential processing → cannot be parallel. • Hard to learn long-range dependencies • Slow inference Tras: attention.	GPT: masked self-attention. decoder! X cross-attention. Input representations: 1. Token embeddings 2. Positional Encoding	$PE(p, 2i) = \sin(w_i p)$ $PE(p, 2i+1) = \cos(w_i p)$ where $w_i = \frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2i}{d_{model}}}}$ p: pos of embedding vectors, i: within the vector, d: dim of model.	$PE(p) = \begin{bmatrix} \sin(w_1 p) \\ \cos(w_1 p) \\ \sin(w_2 p) \\ \vdots \\ \cos(w_{d/2} p) \end{bmatrix}$ p = pos. $w_k = \frac{1}{10000^{\frac{2k-1}{d_{model}}}}$ $k = 1, 2, \dots, d/2$ $PE(p_1) \cdot PE(p_2) = \sum_{k=1}^{d/2} \cos(w_k(p_1 - p_2))$	<u>Attention</u>: measures similarity (relation) between vectors. <u>QKV</u>: Q: 'what do I need right now?' K: 'How should others find me?' V: 'what info do I provide if they pick me?' $W^Q, W^K, W^V \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times d}$ 'differentiable' and learnable
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$$head_i = \text{softmax} \left(\frac{(QW_i^Q)(KW_i^K)^T}{\sqrt{d_K}} \cdot \mathbf{M} \right) (VW_i^V)$$

How to improve performance?

Number of Parameters

• Embedding Layer: $|V| * d_{model}$ (no bias term in embedding layers)

• Positional Encoding:

- Fixed PE: None
- Learned PE: $L_{seq} * d_{model}$ (no bias terms)

• Per-Encoder:

- MHA: $4 * d_{model} * d_{model} + 4 * d_{model} * d_{model}$ (4 Q, K, V, W_v matrices and 1 MHA blocks)

- Large d-model
 - Increase sequence length (100 → 256), larger context
 - Different activation (ReLU → GELU)

	Transformatoren	sind	großartig
Transformatoren	a_{11}	0	0
sind	a_{21}	a_{22}	0
großartig	a_{31}	a_{32}	a_{33}

$$\frac{(QW_i^Q)(KW_i^K)^T}{\sqrt{d_k}} = \begin{bmatrix} q_1 k_1^T & -\infty & -\infty \\ \sqrt{d_1} & & \\ q_2 k_1^T & q_2 k_2^T & -\infty \\ \sqrt{d_2} & \sqrt{d_2} & \\ q_3 k_1^T & q_3 k_2^T & q_3 k_3^T \\ \sqrt{d_3} & \sqrt{d_3} & \sqrt{d_3} \end{bmatrix}$$

FLOPs per Layer with single head

- Attention:
 - Q, K, V Projections
 - $QW^Q, KW^K, VW^V: 3 * (2 * d_{model}) * (L_{seq} * d_{model})$ *changes, reverts the change... it's a sign of overfitting.*
 - Attention Scores (A)
 - $QW^Q(KW^K)^T: (2 * d_{model}) * (L_{seq} * L_{seq})$
 - softmax: $O(L_{seq}^2)$
 - Attention Values
 - $A(VW^V): (2 * L_{seq}) * (L_{seq} * d_{model})$
 - Output Projection
 - $(AVW^V)W_O: (2 * d_{model}) * (L_{seq} * d_{model})$
- FFN
 - $(2 * d_{model}) * (L_{seq} * d_{FF}) + (2 * d_{FF}) * (L_{seq} * d_{model})$
- LN:
 - $O(L_{seq} * d_{model})$

FLOPs per Layer

- Projection: $d_{model} * |V|$ (no bias term in output layer)
- Quadratic in both sequence length and embedding dimension
- For smaller sequences
 - FFN is the bottleneck
- For larger sequences
 - Attention layer is the bottleneck
- KV Caching makes attention cost linear in L_{seq}

Pre-LN is used because putting LayerNorm before the attention/FFN leaves the residual path as a clean identity connection, allowing gradients to flow directly and preventing vanishing/exploding gradients. In Post-LN, gradients must pass through the LayerNorm Jacobian, which disrupts the residual stream and causes instability in deep Transformers.

Also, for LN, training & inference behave the same.